

SULAMAN KHAN

Senior Backend Engineer | Node.js · TypeScript · Distributed Systems

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Full overlap with Gulf hours · 3–4 hours with UK/EU · US mornings covered

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer with 8 years building Node.js services that carry real production load. I have built and owned backend systems end to end: a Node.js platform serving 1M users, a CMS at 100,000+ daily active users, an API tuned to handle 1M+ requests, and a fintech product that processed \$1M+ in its first quarter. I design REST and GraphQL APIs, model and index relational schemas, and make the architectural trade-offs between scalability, maintainability and delivery speed rather than optimising one at the cost of the others. I also spend my current work building production LLM systems, which means I use AI-assisted development daily and have a working view of where it helps and where its output needs to be thrown away.

CORE SKILLS

Backend: Node.js, Express, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Go, PHP/Laravel, REST APIs, GraphQL, gRPC, microservices, event-driven architecture, message queues, system design

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Prisma, schema design, query profiling, indexing strategy, data modelling

Security: Authentication and authorization, JWT and OAuth, transaction signing, fraud prevention, audit logging, regulated-domain compliance (Saudi ZATCA e-invoicing), multi-tenant data isolation

Reliability: Datadog monitoring and alerting, structured logging, error handling, retry with exponential backoff, graceful degradation, load testing, CI/CD

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (Lambda, API Gateway), DigitalOcean, Docker, Kubernetes, Nginx, Cloudflare, GitHub Actions

Frontend: React, React Native, TypeScript, Shopify Polaris

AI-assisted development: GitHub Copilot, Claude, ChatGPT, Cursor for day-to-day delivery; professionally builds LLM systems with LangChain, LangGraph, FastAPI, RAG pipelines and evaluation harnesses

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Engineer

Jan 2024 – Present

Vaival Technologies · Client: Vulcan Forged (US) · Remote

- **Production AI services:** Built LLM systems as async services with token streaming over Server-Sent Events, per-request cost and latency observability, provider-failure handling and retry with exponential backoff. The engineering concerns are ordinary backend ones under new names.
- **Multi-tenant data isolation:** Enforced strict tenant isolation inside the retrieval query rather than filtering results afterwards, and wrote security tests seeding two tenants with deliberately similar data to assert zero cross-tenant results. Directly relevant to any system handling regulated or customer-segregated data.
- **AI tooling in practice:** Use Copilot, Claude and Cursor daily and review every generated line before it ships. Building LLM systems professionally gives me a concrete sense of where these tools are reliable and where their output has to be discarded.

Backend & Blockchain Engineer

Dec 2021 – Mar 2024

Vaival Technologies · Client: Vulcan Forged (US) · Remote

- **Node.js at scale:** Built and operated Node.js and Go services for a Layer 1 blockchain platform — block explorer, decentralized exchange, NFT marketplace, bridge and swap modules — serving real-time on-chain data over GraphQL.
- **Performance diagnosis and ownership:** A Node.js service serving 1M users had memory climbing under load, mitigated only by scheduled restarts. I profiled it, contained the user-facing symptom, then made and executed the case for a Go rewrite rather than patching the same class of bug repeatedly.
- **API throughput:** Optimized an API to handle 1M+ requests through server-resource management, caching and query tuning rather than premature rewrites.

- **Security-critical paths:** Implemented transaction signing, DeFi protocol integration and secure smart-contract interaction on a public network where state is permanent and defects are visible to everyone.

Full Stack Engineer (Web & Mobile)

Jun 2018 – Dec 2021

B4USoft Pvt. Ltd. · Lahore, Pakistan

- **Fintech:** Built secure transaction, authentication, fraud-prevention and data-security features. The launched application processed \$1M+ in transactions in its first quarter.
- **High-traffic systems:** Designed and optimized a CMS supporting 100,000+ daily active users; built React Native applications backed by Node.js and Go APIs with Stripe and PayPal payments and inventory management.
- **Observability and cost:** Instrumented services with Datadog for monitoring and performance tracking; moved workloads to serverless on AWS Lambda with Docker deployment, cutting operational costs 40% while improving scalability.
- **Leadership and quality:** Led projects to CMMI 2.0 certification, established review practices, mentored engineers, raised an app store rating from 4.3 to 4.9 and cut startup time to 10 seconds.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Looqer — AI Shopify App (owned end to end):** Full monorepo: React and Polaris admin dashboard, Node.js, Express and Prisma backend API, vanilla-JS widget runtime embedded in storefronts, and a Shopify theme extension. Deployed on DigitalOcean with Neon PostgreSQL, Nginx, SSL and Cloudflare, including tiered subscription billing across four plans. Architecture through production, single owner.
- **ZATCA Phase 2 E-Invoicing:** Saudi Arabia tax-compliance implementation: Fatoora integration, compliant XML generation and certificate signing. Regulated-domain engineering where the specification admits no approximation. Open-sourced; 13 stars and 7 forks, in use by other teams.
- **Shopify Apps:** Cartly, Sales Pop-up and Wheelify, used by thousands of merchants, shipped inside another platform's API limits, billing rules and review process.
- **Multi-Tenant RAG Service:** Production retrieval API with per-request tenant isolation, streaming responses and cost and latency observability. Architecture write-up published at github.com/sulaman0.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Fintech application processed \$1M+ in transactions within its first quarter post-launch.
- Node.js platform serving 1M users; CMS scaled to 100,000+ daily active users; API tuned to 1M+ requests.
- Cut operational costs 40% through serverless architecture while improving scalability.
- Led projects to CMMI 2.0 certification; app store rating 4.3 to 4.9; startup time cut to 10 seconds.

EDUCATION

B.S. Information Technology

2014 – 2018

University of the Punjab, Lahore, Pakistan

- Applied Concurrency in Go — goroutines, channels, concurrent systems design (2023)